



QUESTIONS TO ASK BEFORE YOU OPEN AN ACCOUNT



How easy is it to open an account?

It can take four weeks to open a business current account. Consider a savings account, if appropriate for your business.



Is there an introductory offer?

If there is an offer such as a free banking period, balance this against future monthly charges.



What are the monthly charges?

Typically, these are payable monthly. Check also whether a minimum balance is required.



What are the transaction charges?

Find out what the bank charges are for paying money in and out as well as for mobile and online transactions.



Is there a relationship manager?

This person works with you on your accounts. Be sure you can contact them easily (face-to-face, phone, email).



Does the bank provide advice?

Find out whether the bank offers advice and market expertise, for example, network events or investment advice.



Is it easy to get an overdraft?

Ask about overdrafts and the terms or charges involved. See whether there are any short-term or quick lending options.



How soon are deposits processed?

Find out how long it takes to process deposits, both large and small. This is important for business cash flow.

PROVIDING DOCUMENTATION

To comply with banking regulations, including those to protect against money laundering, you will need to provide the following documents to open an account in most countries:

Proof of identity such as a passport or identity card.

Proof of address—a utility bill, for example.

Business details, which could be supplied in the form of company registration documents from the relevant national institution, or legal documents, such as Articles of Incorporation.